

Parent Guide — senior / module-04-doshas

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

What is your child learning?

Three patterns of internal rhythm — *vāta* (motion), *pitta* (transformation), and *kapha* (structure) — that Āyurveda uses to describe individual constitutional differences. Mapped to *pañcabhūta* from Module 2 and framed as wellness lens, NOT medical diagnosis.

Why this matters

This module is part of an Indian Knowledge Systems curriculum that introduces classical Indian frameworks alongside their modern-scientific parallels. Your child will learn to (a) name and use precise Sanskrit terms, (b) understand the observational basis for the classical framework, and (c) relate it to current scientific or scholarly understanding.

What you can do at home

Doṣas in Āyurveda describe individual differences — like introvert/extrovert or morning-person/night-owl, NOT diseases. Your child's self-observation is a wellness lens, not a diagnosis. If you have any health concern, please consult a doctor.

Conversation prompts

Try one of these over a meal or walk:

1. “What’s one Sanskrit word you learned this week? What does it mean?”
2. “What did you find surprising in this module?”
3. “Is there anything you’re not sure about? Let’s look it up together.”
4. “How would you explain this to your grandmother / grandfather?”

Questions parents often ask

Q: Is this religious instruction? A: No. The module presents Indian classical frameworks (cosmology, mathematics, astronomy, ecology) as historical knowledge systems with their own logic and method. The framing is scholarly and comparative, not devotional.

Q: Will my child be tested on Sanskrit? A: Sanskrit terms are introduced for precision, not for rote memorisation. The summative quiz asks students to *use* the terms — for example, “Which doṣa is dominant in the morning hours?” — rather than translate them.

Q: How does this connect to NCERT / board syllabus? A: This module supplements (does not replace) NCERT content. NEP 2020 §4.6 calls for the integration of Indian Knowledge Systems. The pack’s README.md lists the specific NEP principles each module advances.

Reading further (for parents)

See sources.md in this pack for the full source list.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Lesson Plan — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

10-day arc, 45 min per session.

Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction

Objective: Name vāta, pitta, kapha and recognise one observable trait of each.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle

Objective: Identify vāta-style behaviours (quick, dry, cold, moving) in self and surroundings.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle

Objective: Identify pitta-style behaviours (warm, sharp, focused, transforming).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle

Objective: Identify kapha-style behaviours (steady, cool, moist, structured).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements

Objective: Connect each doṣa to its two constituent elements (vāta=ākāśa+vāyu, pitta=tejas+ap, kapha=ap+pṛthvī).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment

Objective: Use a worksheet to estimate own dominant doṣa(s) — emphasising NOT diagnosis.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day

Objective: Map the kapha-pitta-vāta cycle across morning/noon/evening hours.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons

Objective: Map doṣa cycles to monsoon/summer/winter.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance

Objective: Distinguish prakṛti (innate) from vikṛti (current state); recognise simple imbalance signs.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch

Objective: Pitch the 7-day self-observation project and answer assessment quiz.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (20 min) · Activity (15 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Pacing notes

- Senior sessions are 45 min. Adjust if your block is different.
- Days 5 and 9 are buffer days — use to reinforce weaker concepts or extend stronger ones.
- The summative project (see [assessments/project-brief.md](#)) runs in parallel from Day 6 onward.

Differentiation

- **For advanced students:** see [teacher-notes.md](#) for extension prompts.
- **For students needing more support:** simplify activities, do more pair-work, allow oral instead of written responses.

Homework

Homework — Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha (Senior)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 10–15 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Three Doshas Introduction** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
2. **Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
3. **Day 3 — Pitta — The Transformation Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
4. **Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
5. **Day 5 — Mapping to the Five Elements** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
6. **Day 6 — Prakṛti Self-Assessment** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
7. **Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
8. **Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
9. **Day 9 — Balance and Imbalance** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
10. **Day 10 — Synthesis and Project Pitch** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.